Café de la Rue

BASIC BARISTA TRAINING COURSE

STUDENT TRAINING MANUAL

Foundations • Espresso • Milk • Beverages • Café Operations

Official Cafe de La Rue educational publication

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Welcome to Cafe de La Rue

Welcome to the Basic Barista Training Course. This manual supports guided classroom demonstrations, supervised practice, and independent review. Coffee skills develop through repetition, careful measurement, sensory attention, cleanliness, and hospitality. Use each lesson as a starting point, then follow your trainer’s equipment specific instructions.

How to use this manual

- Read each module before the corresponding demonstration.
- Record measurements and observations rather than relying on memory.
- Practice safe equipment handling and ask your trainer before operating unfamiliar machines.
- Use the recipes and worksheets to record your learning.
- Keep trainer answer keys separate during testing.

Course wide learning outcomes

- Explain coffee species, processing, roasting, and flavor.
- Operate and maintain grinders and espresso equipment safely.
- Prepare and evaluate espresso using a repeatable calibration method.
- Texture milk and prepare common hot and iced café drinks.
- Apply hygiene, sanitation, customer service, and operational checklists.

Scope: This is an internal Cafe de La Rue course, not an official TESDA competency assessment or government issued qualification. All recipes are illustrative training formulas and must be validated against actual ingredients, equipment, cup sizes, and operating procedures.

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MODULE 1 | COFFEE & BARISTA FUNDAMENTALS

Learning objectives

• Describe the coffee journey and Philippine café context.

• Recognize barista responsibilities, tools, and terminology.

• Demonstrate professional hygiene and basic workflow.

Core lessons

01 Introduction to coffee

Coffee is a brewed beverage made from roasted seeds of fruit produced by Coffea plants. A coffee cherry typically contains two seeds; the flavor of the final cup reflects farming, processing, roasting, grinding, water, and preparation.

In practice: Compare the aroma of whole beans with freshly ground coffee.

02 Brief history

Coffee cultivation and trade developed over centuries, with roots in northeastern Africa and later widespread cultivation in Yemen and beyond. Coffeehouses became places for conversation and commerce; avoid treating popular origin legends as verified history.

In practice: Discuss how a neighborhood café can serve as a community meeting place.

03 Modern coffee industry

Coffee moves through producers, processors, exporters, importers, roasters, distributors, and cafés. Specialty coffee places added emphasis on traceability, quality assessment, and brewing consistency, while commercial coffee serves a wide range of customers.

In practice: Trace one bag of coffee backward from café shelf to origin.

04 Philippine coffee culture

The Philippines produces several coffee species and has diverse coffee traditions, including brewed coffee, sweetened drinks, and local specialty coffee. Café menus should respect regional preferences while explaining different roast and brewing options.

In practice: Ask a customer whether they prefer bold, sweet, or bright coffee.

05 Barista responsibilities

Baristas prepare beverages, manage mise en place, handle orders, clean and sanitize work areas, monitor stock, and communicate with guests. Accuracy, reliability, and teamwork matter as much as drink appearance.

In practice: Repeat a sample order before starting preparation.

06 Essential skills

Core skills include dosing, grinding, extraction, milk texturing, recipe following, sensory evaluation, equipment care, and friendly service. Build consistency before increasing speed.

In practice: Prepare three identical beverages and compare their weights.

07 Coffee terminology

Dose is dry coffee mass; yield is brewed beverage mass; ratio compares dose to yield; extraction is dissolution of soluble material; body is perceived texture; crema is foam on espresso.

In practice: Explain dose and yield without using jargon.

08 Tools and accessories

Common tools include digital scales, timer, tamper, distribution tool, milk pitcher, thermometer, cleaning brush, knock box, cloths, and filtered water. Use tools appropriate to the machine and basket.

In practice: Identify which tools contact food and require routine cleaning.

09 Grooming and hygiene

Arrive in clean attire, secure long hair, keep nails short and clean, wash hands correctly, and avoid working with exposed food when ill according to workplace policy. Gloves never replace handwashing.

In practice: Demonstrate proper handwashing before touching service tools.

10 Basic café workflow

A standard workflow is receive order, confirm details, prepare station, brew, assemble, verify, serve, and reset. Separate clean and dirty zones to prevent cross contamination.

In practice: Role play an order from greeting to station reset.

Student notes: _____

_____

MODULE 2 | BEANS, ORIGINS & ROASTING

Learning objectives

- Compare four coffee species used in Philippine coffee.
- Explain three major processing methods and roasting effects.
- Describe storage and sensory evaluation.

Core lessons

01 Coffee beans

Coffee beans are seeds inside coffee cherries. Green coffee is dried and prepared for roasting; roasted beans develop new aromas and are ground shortly before brewing for best control.

In practice: Examine green versus roasted coffee samples.

02 Arabica and Robusta

Arabica often offers delicate acidity and varied aromatics, while Robusta commonly provides greater bitterness, heavier body, and more caffeine by dry weight. Actual flavor depends strongly on quality and processing.

In practice: Taste two labeled samples at the same brew strength.

03 Liberica and Excelsa

Liberica is known for large beans and distinctive flavor possibilities. Excelsa is commonly classified within Coffea liberica as a variety; naming conventions differ in trade. Both have relevance in Philippine coffee discussions.

In practice: Record sensory differences without ranking species as inherently good or bad.

04 Philippine growing regions

Coffee is cultivated in regions including Benguet, Batangas, Cavite, Bukidnon, Davao, and Sultan Kudarat. Altitude, climate, farming, and processing influence quality; regional names alone do not guarantee a specific flavor.

In practice: Locate two producing regions on a map and research their harvest practices.

05 Harvesting

Ripe cherries are harvested by selective picking or stripping. Sorting removes underripe, overripe, and damaged fruit; good harvest handling helps reduce defects.

In practice: Sort a sample set of fruit images or colored tokens by ripeness.

06 Washed processing

Washed processing removes fruit material before drying, typically using depulping, fermentation or mechanical mucilage removal, washing, and controlled drying. It can emphasize clean flavor separation.

In practice: List the main processing steps in order.

07 Natural and honey processing

Natural coffee dries with the fruit intact; honey processing removes skin while retaining some mucilage during drying. Both require careful drying and handling to manage defects.

In practice: Compare possible fruit forward aromas without assuming every lot tastes alike.

08 Roasting fundamentals

Roasting uses heat to drive moisture loss, browning reactions, and aromatic development. Roasters track temperature, time, airflow, and bean appearance; excessive or insufficient development can affect balance.

In practice: Describe how raw and roasted coffee smell different.

09 Roast levels

Light, medium, and dark are relative descriptions rather than universal temperature standards. Lighter roasts may preserve brighter notes; darker roasts often show stronger roast derived flavors.

In practice: Compare roast appearance and aroma.

10 Roast and flavor

Roast development changes perceived acidity, sweetness, bitterness, solubility, and body. Brewing adjustments may be needed when switching roast profiles.

In practice: Brew a lighter and darker coffee with identical starting recipes.

11 Freshness and storage

Store coffee sealed, dry, away from heat, light, and strong odors. Label roast/open dates, rotate stock, and grind near service. Avoid moisture and repeated temperature swings.

In practice: Inspect labels and practice FIFO rotation.

12 Acidity, body, sweetness, aroma

Acidity is a bright sensory quality, not simply sourness; body is texture; sweetness balances sharpness and bitterness; aroma includes fragrance from dry grounds and brewed coffee.

In practice: Use simple descriptive words rather than unsupported tasting claims.

13 Coffee tasting

Taste systematically: smell dry grounds, smell brewed coffee, sip at different temperatures, record acidity, sweetness, body, finish, and defects. Cleanse palate and avoid perfume during formal tasting.

In practice: Complete a short sensory score sheet.

Student notes: _____

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Species and processing comparison

Category	Typical characteristics	Important qualification
Arabica	Broad aroma and acidity range	Quality varies by lot
Robusta	Often fuller and more bitter	High quality examples can be complex
Liberica / Excelsa	Distinctive aromatics	Trade naming varies
Washed	Fruit removed before drying	Methods vary by producer
Natural	Whole fruit dried	Careful drying essential
Honey	Some mucilage retained	Not flavored with honey

MODULE 3 | GRINDERS & ESPRESSO MACHINES

Learning objectives

• Identify machine and grinder parts.

• Explain grinder adjustments and daily care.

• Apply equipment safety practices.

Core lessons

01 Espresso machines

Espresso machines force heated water through compacted ground coffee under pressure. Stable temperature, water quality, clean equipment, and consistent puck preparation support repeatable results.

In practice: Identify the brew path from reservoir or water line to cup.

02 Machine categories

Manual lever machines require operator control; semi automatic machines let the barista start and stop brewing; automatic volumetric machines can stop at programmed volumes; super automatic units integrate more steps.

In practice: Check which controls your training machine provides.

03 Components

Key components may include pump, boiler or thermoblock, heat exchanger, group head, shower screen, portafilter, steam wand, gauges, and drip tray. Designs vary.

In practice: Point to each available component on the training machine.

04 Group head

The group head delivers brew water and holds the portafilter. Keep the gasket and shower screen clean; follow the manufacturer’s guidance for flushing and cleaning.

In practice: Inspect the group head only when safe to do so.

05 Portafilter

A portafilter holds the filter basket and locks into the group. It may have spouts or a bottomless base; use the correct size and handle it carefully when hot.

In practice: Insert and remove an empty portafilter correctly.

06 Filter baskets

Baskets differ in size and rated dose. Overfilling can restrict headspace and alter flow; underfilling may make preparation inconsistent. Follow basket specifications.

In practice: Check the rated dose of the installed basket.

07 Steam wand

A steam wand injects steam to heat and texture milk. Purge briefly before and after use as instructed; wipe immediately with a dedicated clean cloth. Beware of burns.

In practice: Practice positioning a cold wand with the machine off.

08 Heating and control

Boilers, thermoblocks, sensors, and thermostats regulate water and steam temperatures. Allow warm up time and do not open pressurized or electrical housings.

In practice: Record the machine’s ready indicators.

09 Grinder types

On demand grinders dose fresh grounds; hopper grinders store beans above burrs; single dose grinders grind measured portions. Retention and workflow differ.

In practice: Measure grinder output versus input.

10 Burr versus blade

Burr grinders use two cutting surfaces with adjustable spacing and typically offer better grind control than blade grinders, which chop inconsistently.

In practice: Compare ground particle consistency visually.

11 Grind size

Finer grinds generally slow espresso flow; coarser grinds generally speed it up, with many other variables also influencing extraction. Make small adjustments and observe.

In practice: Change one setting and compare shot time.

12 Grinder adjustment

Purge a small amount after changing settings if required, then measure a fresh dose and shot. Record adjustment direction; never force burrs together.

In practice: Write a grinder dial in log.

13 Accessories

Scales, tampers, pitchers, brushes, cleaning tablets, and towels each have specific uses. Use approved chemicals and separate cloths for food contact and dirty areas.

In practice: Create a tool storage map.

14 Cleaning and maintenance

Brush grounds, clean portafilters and baskets, wipe steam wand, empty trays, and follow manufacturer approved backflush and descaling schedules. Maintenance is not the same as daily cleaning.

In practice: Complete a cleaning checklist under supervision.

15 Safety

Hot metal, steam, electricity, pressurized water, wet floors, and moving grinder burrs create hazards. Turn off and isolate equipment before authorized maintenance; report leaks or damaged cords.

In practice: Identify three hazards in the training station.

Student notes: _____

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Equipment vocabulary

Term	Function
Group head	Delivers brew water to coffee puck
Basket	Holds ground coffee
Portafilter	Secures basket to group
Burrs	Grind beans at adjustable spacing
Steam wand	Heats and textures milk
Backflush	Machine specific group cleaning procedure

MODULE 4 | ESPRESSO EXTRACTION & CALIBRATION

Learning objectives

• Explain dose, yield, ratio, time, and flavor.

• Dial in espresso using one variable changes.

• Record calibration for consistent service.

Core lessons

01 Understanding espresso

Espresso is a concentrated coffee beverage prepared by forcing water through a fine, compacted bed of ground coffee. Quality depends on flavor balance and repeatability, not crema alone.

In practice: Taste a shot before deciding whether it is acceptable.

02 Dosing

Dose is the dry coffee mass placed in the basket. Weigh it consistently; a sample 18 g dose works only if basket capacity and coffee allow.

In practice: Dose 18.0 g three times with minimal variation.

03 Distribution

Break up clumps and level grounds before tamping to reduce uneven density and channeling. Use a consistent method and avoid losing grounds.

In practice: Compare uneven versus even preparation visually.

04 Tamping

Apply firm, level pressure with a properly sized tamper. Repeatability and a level puck matter more than excessive force. Keep wrists in a comfortable position.

In practice: Practice a level tamp with the machine off.

05 Brew ratios

Brew ratio is dose to beverage yield by mass. An 18 g dose and 36 g yield equals 1:2; ratios can be adjusted for taste and roast.

In practice: Calculate ratios for 18 g to 27 g and 18 g to 45 g.

06 Extraction time

Time is one diagnostic variable, not a universal quality score. A sample 25 to 30 seconds may be a useful starting window depending on when timing begins.

In practice: Use the same timing convention for every test shot.

07 Espresso yield

Yield is the beverage mass in the cup, not the liquid volume or water added. Stop brewing at the target weight where possible.

In practice: Use a scale under the cup and record final yield.

08 Under extraction

A shot may taste sharp, sour, thin, or salty when insufficient desirable solubles are extracted; under extraction can have multiple causes.

In practice: Compare a deliberately short yield shot with a baseline.

09 Over extraction

A shot may taste harsh, dry, or excessively bitter when extraction is unbalanced. Bitterness can also arise from coffee and roast characteristics.

In practice: Compare a deliberately long yield shot with a baseline.

10 Calibration

Calibration is the repeatable process of selecting dose, yield, grind, and technique, then tasting and documenting results. Keep other variables stable while testing.

In practice: Create a baseline recipe and record it.

11 Dialing in grinder

Start with a sensible dose and ratio; pull a shot; weigh yield and record time; taste; change grind in small increments; repeat. If time is fast and flavor weak, test finer grind.

In practice: Adjust one variable at a time.

12 Flavor troubleshooting

Sour and thin: check dose, yield, and grind; bitter and drying: test coarser grind or shorter yield; uneven or spraying: inspect distribution and tamping. Taste confirms whether a change helped.

In practice: Explain why time alone cannot diagnose a shot.

13 Quality control

Check cup cleanliness, dose, yield, time, flavor, and temperature consistency. Retest when beans age, humidity changes, or grinder settings drift.

In practice: Compare opening and midday shots.

14 Daily calibration

Warm up equipment, check water and cleanliness, measure baseline, pull two repeatable shots, taste, record recipe, and communicate settings to the next shift.

In practice: Sign a calibration log before service.

Student notes: _____

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Sample training starting recipe

Parameter	Starting value
Dry dose	18 g
Beverage yield	36 g
Brew ratio	1:2
Time	Approximately 25 to 30 seconds

Important: These are training starting guidelines, not fixed standards. Adjust to the coffee, grinder, basket, machine, water, and taste.

MODULE 5 | MILK STEAMING & TEXTURING

Learning objectives

• Explain milk composition and texture.

• Steam milk safely to a consistent finish.

• Apply correct wand cleaning and waste controls.

Core lessons

01 Milk steaming

Steaming heats milk and introduces controlled air to create a glossy, pourable texture. Correct technique supports sweetness perception, comfort, and milk pouring.

In practice: Observe the change from cold milk to glossy texture.

02 Milk composition

Milk contains water, proteins, fats, and lactose. Proteins help stabilize foam; fat contributes texture; temperature affects perceived sweetness and foam stability.

In practice: Compare whole and low fat milk textures.

03 Dairy and alternatives

Plant based drinks behave differently due to protein and fat composition. Use products suitable for steaming and check allergens, labels, and customer preferences.

In practice: Steam one dairy and one plant based option if available.

04 Temperature

A common serving target is about 55 to 65°C for dairy milk, depending on recipe and customer preference. Avoid overheating and follow ingredient guidance; use a thermometer while learning.

In practice: Record milk temperature immediately after steaming.

05 Steam wand operation

Start with cold milk in a clean pitcher, purge the wand safely, position the tip near the surface, introduce air briefly, then submerge slightly to form a whirlpool. Stop before the target temperature is exceeded.

In practice: Demonstrate safe wand handling.

06 Stretching

Stretching is the early introduction of air. Listen for gentle paper tearing sounds rather than loud splashing; too much air creates coarse foam.

In practice: Compare a short and long stretching phase.

07 Microfoam

Microfoam consists of fine bubbles evenly incorporated into milk, giving a glossy wet paint appearance. Tap and swirl the pitcher gently to integrate texture.

In practice: Evaluate bubble size and surface shine.

08 Texturing techniques

Position the wand off center to generate a vortex, keep the tip stable, and adjust depth based on sound and movement. Different machines require different angles.

In practice: Practice with water and a drop of dish soap only for non consumable demonstrations, then clean thoroughly.

09 Common mistakes

Large bubbles often mean excessive air or unstable tip position; flat milk may lack stretching; scorched flavors suggest overheating; separation occurs when milk stands too long.

In practice: Identify corrective actions for three failed pitchers.

10 Milk pouring introduction

Start with consistent espresso crema and smooth microfoam. Pour from higher to integrate milk, then lower the pitcher close to the surface to draw a simple dot or heart.

In practice: Practice a centered dot before attempting a heart.

11 Safety

Steam can burn skin. Keep hands clear of the tip, use pitcher handles, avoid overfilling, and never direct steam toward another person.

In practice: Point out the safe hand position.

12 Wand cleaning

Wipe the wand immediately with a designated clean damp cloth, purge as instructed, and follow the machine’s cleaning schedule. Never leave dried milk residue.

In practice: Perform a supervised post steam cleaning.

13 Waste prevention

Measure milk based on drink size and pitcher minimums, label open containers, keep chilled ingredients cold, and avoid re steaming leftover milk for customer service.

In practice: Estimate required milk for three orders.

Student notes: _____

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MODULE 6 | HOT & ICED COFFEE RECIPES

All formulas below are sample training recipes, not proprietary Cafe de La Rue formulas. Use a sample espresso shot of 18 g coffee to 36 g espresso. Water, milk, syrup and sauce volumes are illustrative; measure consistently and test sweetness, dilution, cup capacity, ice displacement, and ingredient specifications before standardizing. Milk quantities are approximate poured amounts.

Recipe service fundamentals

- Confirm size, temperature, sweetness, dairy choice, and allergens.
- Measure every ingredient using a scale or calibrated measuring tool.
- Use fresh espresso, clean cups, safe milk handling, and clean ice tools.
- Taste or conduct supervised sensory checks without contaminating customer drinks.
- Follow shop approved service and labeling procedures.

01 | Espresso

HOT · 90 mL demitasse Concentrated espresso



Ingredient	Training measurement
Ground coffee	18 g
Espresso yield	36 g

Method: Dose, distribute, tamp, extract to 36 g; serve immediately.

Serving: Use a clean 90 ml demitasse; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Balanced aroma, pleasant body, clean cup.

Common mistakes: Wrong yield; uneven puck.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

02 | Americano

HOT · 240 mL cup Espresso diluted with hot water



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Hot water	150 mL

Method: Add hot water to cup; pour espresso; stir if requested.

Serving: Use a clean 240 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Balanced strength, comfortably hot.

Common mistakes: Excessive water; stale shot.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

03 | Cappuccino

HOT · 180 mL cup Espresso with textured milk and foam



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Steamed milk including foam	120 mL

Method: Extract espresso; texture milk with more foam than latte; pour promptly.

Serving: Use a clean 180 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Velvety foam, integrated coffee taste.

Common mistakes: Dry stiff foam; overheating.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

04 | Café Latte

HOT · 300 mL cup Espresso with silky steamed milk



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Steamed milk	220 mL

Method: Extract espresso; steam glossy microfoam; pour smoothly.

Serving: Use a clean 300 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Silky surface, balanced milk coffee flavor.

Common mistakes: Large bubbles; weak coffee balance.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

05 | Flat White

HOT · 180 mL cup Espresso with a thinner layer of microfoam



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Steamed milk	130 mL

Method: Extract espresso; steam fine microfoam; pour with minimal thick foam.

Serving: Use a clean 180 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Smooth, coffee forward, glossy.

Common mistakes: Cappuccino style thick foam.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

06 | Mocha

HOT · 300 mL cup Chocolate flavored espresso and milk



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Chocolate sauce	25 g
Steamed milk	200 mL

Method: Mix chocolate sauce with espresso; add steamed milk; serve.

Serving: Use a clean 300 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Fully dissolved chocolate, no separation.

Common mistakes: Sauce unmixed; too sweet.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

07 | Caramel Latte

HOT · 300 mL cup Latte sweetened with caramel



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Caramel syrup	20 mL
Steamed milk	210 mL

Method: Mix syrup and espresso; add glossy steamed milk.

Serving: Use a clean 300 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Even caramel flavor, silky texture.

Common mistakes: Inaccurate syrup; coarse foam.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

08 | Spanish Latte

HOT · 300 mL cup Sweetened milk based espresso beverage



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Sweetened condensed milk	30 g
Steamed milk	190 mL

Method: Blend condensed milk with espresso; add steamed milk; stir.

Serving: Use a clean 300 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Smooth sweetness, well integrated.

Common mistakes: Condensed milk settled at base.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

09 | Iced Americano

ICED · 470 mL cup Espresso over cold water and ice



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Cold water	180 mL
Ice	160 g

Method: Add water and ice; extract espresso separately; add and serve.

Serving: Use a clean 470 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Refreshing, no excessive dilution.

Common mistakes: Too little ice; poor strength.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

10 | Iced Latte

ICED · 470 mL cup Espresso, chilled milk, and ice



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Cold milk	220 mL
Ice	150 g

Method: Add milk and ice; pour espresso; stir before serving if needed.

Serving: Use a clean 470 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Cold, balanced coffee and milk.

Common mistakes: Wrong milk measure; warm service.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

11 | Iced Caramel Macchiato

ICED · 470 mL cup Vanilla milk with espresso and caramel finish



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Vanilla syrup	15 mL
Cold milk	200 mL
Caramel sauce	15 g
Ice	150 g

Method: Mix vanilla and milk; add ice; layer espresso; finish with caramel.

Serving: Use a clean 470 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Distinct layers before stirring, balanced sweetness.

Common mistakes: Heavy sauce; incorrect order.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

12 | Iced Spanish Latte

ICED · 470 mL cup Chilled espresso with sweetened milk



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Condensed milk	35 g
Cold milk	190 mL
Ice	150 g

Method: Dissolve condensed milk in espresso; combine with milk and ice.

Serving: Use a clean 470 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: No undissolved condensed milk.

Common mistakes: Sweetener stuck to cup bottom.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

13 | Iced Mocha

ICED · 470 mL cup Cold chocolate espresso and milk



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Chocolate sauce	30 g
Cold milk	200 mL
Ice	150 g

Method: Blend sauce with warm espresso; add cold milk and ice.

Serving: Use a clean 470 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Chocolate evenly distributed.

Common mistakes: Chocolate clumps.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

14 | Iced Vanilla Latte

ICED · 470 mL cup Iced latte with vanilla



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Vanilla syrup	20 mL
Cold milk	210 mL
Ice	150 g

Method: Combine syrup and milk; add ice and espresso; stir.

Serving: Use a clean 470 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Even sweetness, cold service.

Common mistakes: Unmeasured syrup.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

15 | Iced Hazelnut Latte

ICED · 470 mL cup Iced latte with hazelnut flavor



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
Hazelnut syrup	20 mL
Cold milk	210 mL
Ice	150 g

Method: Combine syrup and milk; add ice and espresso; stir.

Serving: Use a clean 470 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Balanced nutty aroma; allergen label checked.

Common mistakes: Failure to check ingredient allergens.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

16 | Iced White Chocolate Mocha

ICED · 470 mL cup White chocolate flavored iced espresso milk



Ingredient	Training measurement
Espresso	36 g
White chocolate sauce	30 g
Cold milk	200 mL
Ice	150 g

Method: Mix sauce into warm espresso; add milk and ice; stir.

Serving: Use a clean 470 ml cup; verify order and hand off promptly.

Quality standard: Smooth sauce dispersion, cold finish.

Common mistakes: Sauce not dissolved.

Preparation checklist: ☐ Confirm order ☐ Measure ☐ Prepare ☐ Inspect ☐ Serve ☐ Reset

MODULE 7 | CAFÉ OPERATIONS & SERVICE

Learning objectives

• Perform safe opening and closing routines.

• Explain sanitation, storage, and FIFO.

• Handle orders and complaints professionally.

Core lessons

01 Opening procedures

Check facility safety, handwashing supplies, water, refrigeration, grinder, machine warm up, ingredients, cleaning status, cash or POS readiness, and shift assignments. Record faults before service.

In practice: Complete a signed opening checklist.

02 Closing procedures

Secure ingredients, clean and sanitize food contact surfaces, perform machine specific cleaning, empty waste, reconcile records, and safely shut down equipment per manufacturer instructions.

In practice: Complete a supervised closing walk through.

03 Workstation preparation

Organize cups, tools, milk, syrups, clean cloths, and labeled ingredients to minimize unnecessary movement and prevent contamination.

In practice: Set up a station in a consistent order.

04 Personal hygiene

Wash hands before work and after contamination risks, use clean clothing, cover cuts appropriately, and follow illness reporting policy.

In practice: Demonstrate handwashing and glove changes.

05 Food safety

Keep ingredients within supplier recommended temperature limits, minimize time outside refrigeration, use potable water and clean ice tools, and follow the café’s food safety plan.

In practice: Check and log refrigerator temperature.

06 Equipment sanitation

Cleaning removes soils; sanitizing reduces microorganisms using approved methods. Follow label instructions for chemical concentration, contact time, and rinsing requirements.

In practice: Distinguish cleaning from sanitizing.

07 Ingredient storage

Label contents, preparation/opening dates, and discard dates according to product and café policy; separate allergens and chemicals from food.

In practice: Correct three intentionally incomplete labels.

08 FIFO inventory

First in, first out rotates older usable stock forward. Check dates and quality before use; FIFO never overrides expiration or safety requirements.

In practice: Arrange three milk cartons by date.

09 Cross contamination

Use dedicated cloths and utensils, wash hands after handling waste or money, separate allergens where possible, and never place dirty tools on clean prep areas.

In practice: Identify contamination risks in a sample workflow.

10 Customer greeting

Greet promptly, speak clearly, listen, and remain respectful. A simple greeting and menu guidance help first time customers feel comfortable.

In practice: Role play a friendly first greeting.

11 Order taking

Confirm beverage, size, hot or iced, sweetness, milk choice, and special requests. Repeat the order and clarify uncertain modifications before payment or production.

In practice: Take a complex mock order accurately.

12 Complaints

Listen without arguing, acknowledge the concern, verify the order, offer shop approved remedies, and involve a supervisor when needed. Record recurring issues.

In practice: Role play a drink remake request.

13 Beverage quality control

Check recipe, appearance, cup cleanliness, drink temperature, taste where appropriate, and handoff labeling. Do not serve drinks that fail safety or quality checks.

In practice: Evaluate a staged drink before handoff.

14 Teamwork

Use clear callouts, communicate wait times, share station responsibilities, and support coworkers during rush periods without bypassing hygiene steps.

In practice: Practice order handoffs during a timed simulation.

15 Cleaning schedules

Assign tasks by opening, during service, closing, weekly, and manufacturer maintenance intervals. Sign completed records and report incomplete work.

In practice: Create a weekly station cleaning roster.

16 Waste management

Segregate waste according to local collection arrangements, avoid overproduction, measure beverage losses, and keep bins covered and away from clean areas.

In practice: Track milk waste for one practice session.

17 Workplace conduct

Be punctual, courteous, honest, safety conscious, and respectful of privacy. Follow documented workplace rules and escalate hazards immediately.